All in the Timing

By Jason Sheets

INTRODUCTION

An average day in the typical American father's life is unmemorable. We average man lives his life on autopilot. We put off until tomorrow what should be done today. We forget promises we've made. We cut corners. We procrastinate. We go through the motions, ignoring the clock that is ticking our lives away. Maybe one day, one man will be fortunate enough to realize that it's "All in the Timing" by Jason Sheets

6:55 AM Snooze alarm

7 :00 AM Wake up

7:02 AM Shave

7:05 AM Shower

7:15 AM Comb hair

7:16 AM Dress

7:30 AM Breakfast

7 :40 AM Brush teeth

7:50 AM Leave for work

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7:59 AM Arrive at work

There.

Got it.

Wait-

What if I have to go to the bathroom? Damn!

6:50 AM Snooze alarm

6:55 AM Wake up ...

Tick, tick, tick

Tick, tick, tick, tick ...

What?? Pick up what? No.

No.

I don't have the time. Yeah, love you, too. Later.

No.

Later.

9:00 Check e-mail

9:06 Open e-mail

9: 15 Check voice- mail

9:18 Check faxes

9:20 Answer beeper

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9:25 Return calls

9:35 Check e-mail again

9:38 Check faxes again

9:45 Start workday

Now let me get this straight. I sign on with your

company, I spend the next 45 years of my life

making money *for you,*

working on *your* schedule,

your pay rates, *your* promotion standards,

with *your* hand-picked people who are supposed to

become my respected colleagues.

Every 50 weeks

you'll grant me 2

weeks off where I can

go to Tahiti and spend the little money I've saved

on coconut flavored milkshakes for the

whole family.

And, after my 45

years, you'll throw

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a party for me that

lasts 2 hours and

that half the people

will make up reasons

not to go and half

of the half

that do show up

will get my name wrong. Then, you'll give me an

engraved watch

that isn't even a Timex. Is that right?

fine.

Sign me up.

This is a much better deal than I expected.

11:30 Remember that you forgot lunch at home

11:31 Use profanity

11:35 Agree to go to lunch with boring, useless,

drips of society

12:00 During lunch, mentally use profanity.

No, I haven't read the new Grisham novel. No, I

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didn't see the game last night.

No, I haven't seen Calvin Klein's new fall fashions.

No, I haven't volunteered to teach Church Bible School. But, I do know that gas is selling at the Marathon station for just a dollar-five.

See -

I haven't missed out on everything.

You're doing what?

Save that for home.

You're on the clock.

Tick, tick, tick,

Tick, tick, tick, tick.

Not today.

I haven't got the time

When I'm a parent,

I'm going to do everything differently.

I'm going to play catch with my son every evening that it's not raining.

I'm going to sit my daughter on my knee

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and let her bounce up and down. I'm going to bring my wife roses every Friday.

I'm going to fix up the house. Learn to cook.

Fix my wife breakfast in bed. Build my kids a tree-house. Do my own oil changes.

Help my son get more Cub Scout badges than anyone else.

Get in shape.

Get a life.

Get a hobby.

When will I find the time to do all this?

I'm not worried.

I'll *make* time.

Tick, tick, tick

5:00 Return home

5:01 See list of jobs that you posted on the refrigerator

5:03 Get beer

5:05 Start jobs

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No, mom.

Can't make it home this year. You know how it is.

Next year.

I promise.

Right now I just don't have the time.

Can't you see? Daddy's busy.

Go play with one of the kids over there.

One of them must like you. Go play.

Can't you see? Daddy's busy.

Daddy's tired.

He works very hard. This is his vacation. Go play.

Go see mommy.

Yes, we'll go see the ponies. Tomorrow.

Not right now.

Can't you see

Daddy's busy.

Tick, tick, tick, tick, tick Dear dad,

I'm sorry I never made it back

in time to see you.

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Mom didn't tell me that it was serious this time.

If I had known that this would

be it,

I would have made the time. I would have found the

time. I would have, dad.

I would have.

Quiet!

The game's on! Go ask your mom.

Honey - the kids want to practice for some spelling

bee or something.

Can you help them out? The game's on!

Tick, tick, tick,

Tick, tick, tick, tick.

So when are you two going to have kids? She's 33.

Don't forget about that biological clock.

Tick, tick, tick, Tick, tick, tick, tick.

They're done. Eight down with

a minute to play. Comeback?

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Nah

They haven't got the time.

10:28 Collapse in bed

10:30 Wearily watch "Nightline"

10:32 Fall asleep

2:00 am. Realize you forgot to tell your wife you lo-

2:02 Mental note to tell her in the morning

So where did all the time go?

It flits away and you don't even know when it

happens.

Time rapes you.

From your family.

From your friends.

From your own existence. We let it happen.

We know it's happening. We'd realize it's happening

... if

we'd taken the time.

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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